COS/87/2/Sy

RAF Police Flight
RAF Cosford
Wolverhampton
West Midlands
WV7 3EX

Mar 93

OC RAF Police Flt

Sir,

POSSIBLE UFO SIGHTINGS

1. I have to report that at RAF Cosford on 31 Mar 93 at 0115 hours in company with Cpl Section 40 RAF Police, I was on mobile patrol of Leeming Road, adjacent to the Gravel Car Park when I saw two bright lights in the sky above the Airfield. The lights appeared to be flying at great velocity in a South Easterly direction at an altitude of approximately 1000 feet. The lights were circular in shape and gave off no beam. They were creamy white in colour and constant in size and in relation to each other.

2. I brought the vehicle to a standstill and pointed out the lights to Cpl Section 40 I switched off the vehicle engine and we both got out of the car and observed the lights. There was no sound of any engine noise despite there being no wind and the sky being free from cloud. The lights were observed over-flying the Unit and away towards the Wolverhampton area. A slight red glow could be seen from the rear of the lights as they disappeared from view over the horizon. The lights were visible for approximately one minute.

3. Myself and Section 40 then returned to the COC and I contacted RAF Shawbury. I was informed that there were no aircraft flying from there.

4. At 0125 hours, I contacted ATC at RAF Lyneham and was informed that there were no known aircraft in the area of Cosford.

5. At 0127 hours, I contacted RAF Brize Norton and was informed the same.

6. At 0128 hours, I was informed by the Ord Cpl, Cpl Section 40 that a Section 40 Rugeley, Staffordshire had reported seeing the same lights over Rugeley. Four members of Section 40 party had also witnessed the lights. Section 40 had followed the lights which he described as being cream in colour at an altitude of 900-1000 feet and an estimated size of 200 metres. He could hear a humming noise as the object flew directly above him. Section 40 stated that he believed that the object landed in an area known as Hazelslade but when he approached he could not find any signs of the landing. Section 40 was instructed to inform his local Civil Police Force, which he did, and during a subsequent conversation, it was established that a Constable from Staffordshire Police had visited Section 40

7. At 0130 hours, I informed West Mercia Police, WPC Section 40 of the sightings.

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8. At 0140 hours, I informed HQ P&SS (UK), Cpl Section 40, of the incident.

9. At 0142 hours, I informed RAF West Drayton, Lt Cdr Section 40 of the incident, and he confirmed that there was no military aircraft of any kind in UK airspace and there had not been since 0001 hours.

10. At 0143 hours, the Senior Air Traffic Controller at Birmingham International Airport was contacted, and he confirmed that there were no civilian aircraft in Cosford Airspace and had not been for some hours.

11. At 0215 hours, OC RAF Police Flt and the Ord Off, Flt Lt Section 40 were informed of the incident.

12. At 0250 hours, Section 40 RAF Shawbury Met Office, contacted Cpl Section 40 and stated that he had seen two lights in the sky at RAF Shawbury. The lights were first sighted approximately 15-20 kms away and Section 40 observed them travel towards him over the Airfield moving erratically at hundreds of miles per hour unlike any aircraft. He described the lights as appearing to be searching for something. He heard a low humming noise and watched the object for 5 minutes until it disappeared from sight in a southerly direction. Section 40 stated that he had been a Met Officer for 8 years and had never seen anything like it before.

13. At 0300 hours, Cpl Section 40 contacted a Section 40 the Met Officer at Bristol Airport, who stated that similar lights had been seen there at 0055 hours. He had initiallly put the llights down to adverse meteor activity but in the light of the subsequent reports recorded it as unidentified.

14. At 0310 hours, West Mercia Police were made aware of the further reports and would contact Staffordshire and Avon & Somerset Forces to correlate the reports.

15. At 0330 hours I resumed normal duties.

Section 40
Cpl Section 40
RAF Police

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LOOSE MINUTE

D/Sec(AS)12/1

16 Apr 93

Head of Sec(AS) - through Section 40

Copy to:
Section 40

SIGHTINGS OF UNIDENTIFIED OBJECT - WEDNESDAY 31 MARCH

1. In the early hours of Wednesday 31 March an unidentified object was seen over several parts of the UK. Most of the sightings were in Devon and Cornwall, South Wales and Shropshire, although reports were received from other locations. We are aware of at least 30 or 40 people who witnessed something, although this number is growing.

2. Aside from the fact that so many people reported seeing something strange, a number of other factors combine to make these sightings highly unusual; firstly, there is some commonality in the description of the object, and considerable commonality in the times of the sightings (around 1.10am). Secondly, none of the usual explanations for UFOs seem applicable, and thirdly, the reliability of the witnesses, most of whom were police officers, and some of whom were military and civil aviation personnel. I have attached the report made by a Corporal at RAF Cosford, together with three of the many other reports, as illustrations.

3. As far as can be ascertained, no military aircraft of any kind were operating in UK airspace at the time, as confirmed by both HQ MATO at RAF Uxbridge, and RAF West Drayton.

4. Sector Operations Centre (South) at RAF Neatishead have told D Air Def's staff that nothing was detected on Air Defence radar. London Air Traffic Control Centre (Military) confirmed that nothing was detected on Air Traffic Control radar.

5. RAF Fylingdales told me that a Russian rocket re-entering the atmosphere at 12.10am would have been visible from the UK, but this time does not match the majority of the sightings; furthermore, the descriptions from witnesses are not consistent with this explanation. The Royal Observatory at Greenwich were aware of no meteorite showers or similar occurrences.

6. DI55c have been consulted, but have not as yet been able to come to any conclusions about the sightings.

7. Some of the reports state that the object was moving at a very high speed (one estimate, based on timing the object over a known distance, was of 1100 mph), while some reported that the object hovered, moved slowly, and then flew off at high speed. This, together with some of the other descriptions given, suggests Aurora. Notwithstanding the US denials, these sightings might prompt renewed speculation.

8. The UK's two main UFO groups are well aware of this wave of sightings, and have told me that they have received many reports themselves. At least one local newspaper has reported the sightings. Although we have not received any press enquiries yet, there is always a possibility that questions will be asked, and it might be difficult to maintain our usual line that no further action was being taken as the sightings had been looked at, and were judged to be of no defence significance.

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9. I have spoken to as many of the police and military witnesses as I could contact; nearly everyone I spoke to said that the object was unlike anything they had ever seen before.

10. Given the above, it would not seem sufficient to simply write these sightings off. It seems that an unidentified object of unknown origin was operating in the UK Air Defence Region without being detected on radar; this would appear to be of considerable defence significance, and I recommend that we investigate further, within MOD or with the US authorities.

Section 40 [redacted]

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LOOSE MINUTE

D/Sec(AS)12/7(JC106/93)

22 April 1993

ACAS

SIGHTINGS OF UNIDENTIFIED OBJECT

1. I do not normally concern you with the UFO aspect of Sec(AS)'s work but in the light of previous conversations we have had, you may wish to be aware of a recent particularly unusual incidence of UFO sightings over the UK, involving descriptions that match some of the reported characteristics of the so-called "Aurora".

2. The sightings took place over a period of about 3 hours early on Wednesday 31 March. Most of them were in Devon and Cornwall, South Wales and Shropshire. There is a number of factors which make these sightings unusual; firstly, there is a good deal of commonality in the description of the object, and considerable commonality in the times of many of the sightings - around 1.10 am (although several occurred in locations some distance apart at about the same time indicating the possibility of more than one phenomenon); secondly, none of the usual explanations put forward to explain UFO sightings seem applicable; and thirdly, the reliability of the witnesses, a good many of whom were police officers and military personnel. Our latest information indicates that at least seventy people witnessed something, and I have attached a small selection of the reports.

3. My staff have made extensive efforts to find an explanation for these sightings, including discussions with air defence and both civil and military ATC authorities; generally it has been confirmed that nothing unusual was seen, and no requests for clearance for any "unusual activity" have been acknowledged to have been received. However the ATC radar at Burrington recorded some slow moving contacts over North Devon at the same time as some of the sightings in that area were reported. Despite this coincidence West Drayton suggest these recordings could be attributed to clutter. The only other main ATC radar (Clee Hill) which might have picked up contacts in the area in which sightings were reported was in fact not working on primary radar during the period of the sightings and therefore only aircraft working Secondary Surveillance Radar could be seen. Routine checks have advised us that there were no military aircraft operating at the time.

4. Some of the reports state that the object was moving at a very high speed, while some say that it was hovering or moving very slowly. Many of the reports refer to the object being very large, flying low and making a low humming sound. My staff have spoken to a number of the military and police witnesses, many of whom commented that the object was unlike anything they had ever seen before; a

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Met Officer at RAF Shawbury reported seeing the object projecting a narrow beam of light at the ground at a height of 400-500 feet and estimated its size at somewhere between a CI30 and B747 when it passed over his head at an estimated 4000 feet.

5. In summary, there would seem to be some evidence on this occasion that an unidentified object (or objects) of unknown origin was operating over the UK. Given recent speculation about Aurora by both media and MPs it is surprising that so far this has not been taken up by the Press or, indeed, again by MPs. Frankly, I can see little that we can do to follow it up. If there has been some activity of US origins which is known to a limited circle in MOD and is not being acknowledged it is difficult to investigate further. I would however be interested in your views in the light of your earlier interest about Aurora. I attach a copy of a letter I sent to the US Embassy not long ago which I am assured has been disseminated to all "interested Agencies" in the US.

Section 40 [redacted]

Head of Sec(AS)

Section 40 [redacted]

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